They began to march from Hangū to Thāl. They were able to reach Thāl below Bangash with a night's halt. There too Babur's men made a tower of heads from each one who couldn't escape.

Barging into Bannū and 'Īsa-khail

Leaving from Thāl, they went without a road, right down a steep descent, through narrow strips laid on the road. They halted for a night by the side and very next day came down into Bannū. Each man, horse and camel were all worn out with fatigue. A load of booty was making things miserable on the irregular road, which did not seem fit for riding. The regular road was still a few miles away on the right. The irregular route was known as Gosfandliyār (sheep road; *liyār* is Afghānī for a road). These narrow streets were used by the shepherds and herdsmen to take their flocks and herds. Most of the people in Babur's camp had begun to say that this idea of the left-hand road was a bad idea from Malik Bū-sa'īd Kamarī.

The Bannū lands had very low elevation. They lay immediately outside the Bangash and Naghr hills to the north. The Bangash torrent of the Kūrām River comes down into Bannū making it highly fertile. Sindh River existed to the south-east. To the east lay Dīn-kot and the west existed plain lands known as Bāzār and Tāq. The land of Bannū was cultivated by the Afghān tribesmen like Kurānī, Kīwī, Sūr, 'Īsa-khail and Nīā-zāī, etc.

After dismounting in Bannū, they heard that the tribesmen (Kīwī) in the plain were going to launch a resistance and with that intent, they had begun entrenching themselves on a hill to the north. Babur sent a force headed by Jahāngīr Mīrzā against them in their sanger. He slaughtered them mercilessly, creating yet another tower of heads. After the sanger had been taken, the Kīwī headman, Shādī Khān, came to Babur, with grass between his teeth. He paid obeisance to Babur. Interestingly, Babur took a different stance, atypical of the Tīmūrid practice—he not only pardoned Shādī Khān, but all the prisoners.

As per the decision of counsel post-takeover of Kohāt, they were to return to Kābul after overrunning Bangash and Bannū through Naghr or Farmūl. But when Bannū had been overrun, people familiar with the locality suggested that the plains were close by, with good roads and abundant wealth. Hence the decision was reviewed, and it was settled to take over the plain and then return to Kābul via Farmūl.

Marching the next day, they dismounted at a spot in 'Īsa-khail village by the bank of river Kūrām. The villagers had gone into the Chaupāra Hills after hearing of Babur's arrival. Babur left the spot where he had dismounted and